

the top of the toolbar. The trash can below it deletes all the icons in a node.

To highlight entire trees, you can use ~clouds~, which can encompass nodes and all their children. Just right-click on the node and go to Insert > Cloud. You can then change the cloud's colour by right-clicking on any node in the cloud and selecting Format > Cloud Color.

This pretty much covers the basics; let's see what else is possible with these nodes...

9.3 More Work With Nodes

It's quite easy to grasp the basics of FreeMind with a couple of hours' use - it's a fairly easy program to learn - but there's a lot more that you don't get to see right away.

9.3.1 Linking Nodes

You don't always need to restrict yourself to the parent-child or sibling relationship for nodes. If you find that two nodes are related but belong to different trees, you can create ~graphical links~ between them. Just right-click on the first node and drag your cursor to the node you want to relate it to. You don't need to bother about the direction of the relationship - you can format the arrow later. As you do so, you'll notice a highlight appear on the second node - this lets you choose whether the link will point to the top of the node or its open side. This screenshot should be more illustrative:

To tweak the shape of the graphical links, click on it and drag it around. If you click closer to one of the ends, it'll be affected more than the other. Right-clicking on the link lets you select the direction of the arrow and change its colour as well.

You can also use ~local hyperlinks~ to link nodes, so clicking on one node will take you to the other. This doesn't seem too use-